

Fangzhou Sha

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Citizenship: China | Visa Status: F-1

Research Fields

Macroeconomics; Monetary Economics; Applied Macroeconomics

Education

Southern Methodist University

Expected 2027

Ph.D. in Economics

Committee: Nathan S. Balke (Chair), Rocío Madera, Ömer Özak, Michael Sposi

Southern Methodist University

2023

M.A. in Economics

University of Wisconsin–Madison

2021

M.S. in Economics

Shanghai University of Finance and Economics

2019

B.B.A. in Accounting

Research

Job Market Paper

Fiscal Backing and Heterogeneous Household Portfolios

Develops a heterogeneous-agent model with household portfolio heterogeneity to ask when government deficits become inflationary. Differences in household spending responses account for only a limited share of the effects of fiscal expansions, while expectations about whether government debt is backed by future surpluses play a substantially larger role.

Working Papers

- *Fiscal Policy, Inflation Stabilization, and Monetary-Fiscal Interaction*
- *Identifying the Effects of Funded vs. Unfunded Fiscal Shocks*
with Nathan S. Balke and Carlos Zarazaga

Work in Progress

- *Financial Frictions, Firm Exit, and Aggregate Dynamics*
with Nathan S. Balke and Enrique Martínez-García

Selected Presentations

Fiscal Backing and Heterogeneous Household Portfolios

- RISE Conference, Federal Reserve Bank of Cleveland, Cleveland, OH 2026
- Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Houston, TX 2026
- SMU Economics Brown Bag, Southern Methodist University, Dallas, TX 2025, 2026
- Southern Economic Association Graduate Student Sessions, Tampa, FL 2025
- North Texas Economic Conference, University of Texas at Arlington, Arlington, TX 2025

Awards and Fellowships

- Dean's Dissertation Fellowship, Southern Methodist University 2026
- Melody Rice Memorial Award, Southern Methodist University 2026
- Outstanding Graduate Student Award, Southern Economic Association 2025

- Outstanding Graduate Student Instruction Award, Southern Methodist University 2025
- Provost's Summer Research Grant, Southern Methodist University 2025
- Best Third-Year Paper Award, Department of Economics, Southern Methodist University 2024
- Provost's Doctoral Candidacy Fellowship, Southern Methodist University 2023–2026
- Nomination, Best Master's Thesis, University of Wisconsin–Madison 2021
- Xu Zhendan Scholarship, Shanghai University of Finance and Economics 2018

Teaching Experience

Southern Methodist University

Teaching Award: **Outstanding Graduate Student Instruction Award**, SMU 2025

Instructor: Intermediate Macroeconomics

Invited Speaker: Teaching Strategies and Tools Workshop, Moody School Leadership Academy

Teaching Assistant: Intermediate Macroeconomics; Applied Econometric Analysis; Principles of Macroeconomics (Honors); Micro Theory II; Predictive Analytics; Forecasting

Research Methods and Technical Skills

Macroeconomic Modeling: DSGE models; heterogeneous-agent models; linear rational-expectations models

Econometrics: Structural VARs; time-series econometrics

Computational Methods: Dynamic programming; endogenous grid methods; numerical solution methods

Programming: Julia; MATLAB; Python; L^AT_EX